



DICK CULLUM

IT IS GOOD news that Andy Cohen is coming back to play in the annual Saints-Millers Old Timers Game July 16.

Andy was one of the most popular of the old Millers. He has given his life to baseball ever since.

You will have difficulty naming a player who let his head do more than Andy to extend his physical capabilities.

Watching him play, you wondered how one second baseman could know so much more than other second basemen about how to play the batter.

It took Millers' fans a while to appreciate Andy because they seldom saw him make a spectacular play.

At last, after he had been around long enough, fans realized that he was making the play in his head before the pitch. He was getting to or leaning toward the point where the batted ball would go.

Andy had no startling assets in speed, throwing arm or batting punch. He made his contribution by never doing anything wrong.

He frustrated opponents by killing their efforts in such an offhand way that he made their good efforts seem feeble.

He was not a high average batter, excepting for one or two good seasons, but his ratio of run-scoring hits to total hits was the highest.

He was also one of the Millers' most popular men, among teammates and opponents as well as among fans.

John McGraw of the New York Giants was always on the hunt for a Jewish player to appeal to the large body of Jewish fans in New York. He passed up Hank Greenberg in one of his faulty judgments, but he gave Cohen a good try. Andy fell just short of meeting McGraw's requirements although he had one year in which he batted .294 in 101 games. He came to the Millers after that. Through seven years of service he became one of the fans' best remembered heroes and one of owner-manager Mike Kelley's favorite people.

End of Line for Maris

GUSSIE BUSCH lost a good baseball player but gained a good beer salesman.

Roger Maris will quit the St. Louis Cardinals at the end of the season because his beer distributorship in Gainesville, Fla., is doing so well it demands his full time.

During his many years in the American League, Maris was not a popular player, but he was a good one. His rare talent for antagonizing fans obscured his excellence as a right fielder, one of the best in the league for many years.

How drastically baseball form can fluctuate from season to season is better illustrated nowhere than in Maris' 61 home runs in 1961 by one who has averaged 19 home runs a season in the rest of his career and had a previous high of 39.

True, Maris' 61 home runs were hit in a schedule running eight games longer than the schedule in which Babe Ruth hit 60. Just the same it was one of baseball's most spectacular records.

It is also one of baseball's least enthusiastically acclaimed records.

Maybe because Maris did it, or maybe because it reflected in a way on Ruth's feat—but, whatever the reason, baseball fans kind of wish Maris hadn't done it.